Our analysis makes clear that sidelining strategies are a key element of IOs' adaptive toolkit. Sidelining can enable IOs to navigate hostile environments while safeguarding their missions and values. By leveraging their networks and cooperating with other organizations, IOs can maintain operational effectiveness and relevance on the global stage. Crucially, this approach allows IOs to circumvent the need to compromise their goals or norms to appease populists.

However, sidelining also has downsides. This strategy may further alienate populist states, potentially exacerbating tensions and depriving IOs of the contributions these members might otherwise offer. Moreover, its success depends on the availability and quality of alternative information and resources. In such cases, combining sidelining with appeasement may be necessary to strike a balance between maintaining core principles and ensuring broader organizational stability—a topic we turn to in the next chapter.

1. "Burning the Data: Attacks on Climate and Energy Data and Research," Center for American Progress, 2018, https://www.americanprogress.org/article/burning-the-data/; "Science Under Attack: How Trump Is Sidelining Researchers and Their Work," *New York Times*, 2019, https://www.nytimes.com/2019/12/28/climate/trump-administration-war-on-science.html.

2. See Jones and Hilbers (2004).

3. Interviews with senior officials at health, environmental, and energy IOs conducted by the authors, January and February 2021.

4. Interviews with IO officials, January and February 2021; see also Cory, Lerner, and Osgood (2021).

5. Suspicious or incomplete data flagged by IOs may simply be omitted, appearing as missing data in official reports. Interview conducted by authors. Senior official at an environmental and energy IO, January 25, 2021.

6. Senior official at an environmental IO. Interview by authors. January 25, 2021.

7. Senior official at a leading environmental IO. Interview by authors. January 26, 2020.

8. Senior official at a leading health IO. Interview by authors. January 22, 2021.

9. Data collected by authors.

10. See "US 'Hid Iraq Chemical Weapons Incidents.'" *BBC News*. October 15, 2014. https://www.bbc.com/news/world-us-canada-29631829.

11. Former IMF official. Interview by authors. June 8, 2021.

12. See "Memorandum of Cooperation Between the Eurasian Development Bank and the Asian Infrastructure Investment Bank." https://www.aiib.org/en/about-aiib/who-we-are/partnership/_download/MOU-Eurasian-Development-Bank.pdf.

13. Information-sharing agreements could not have been signed when the World Bank was the only IO active in the development area (1945–1956).

14. Development is distinct from areas like emergency lending, in which few IOs operate (Lipscy 2015), or environmental governance, where IOs are fragmented and hierarchically ordered (Keohane